



IS SCIENCE TRULY OPEN TO EVERYONE?

What role should the public play in research? And should all researchers openly share their teaching materials? Research and education are shifting towards greater collaboration and transparency, but how far are we willing to go? Join the discussion on the future of Citizen Science and Open Education in a thought-provoking lecture on 11 February, organized by Radboud Reflects, the Radboud Open Science Programme, and the Open Science Community Nijmegen. This event marks **the official relaunch of OSCN**. There will be drinks and ample opportunity to further discuss these - and other - topics after the event. You can reserve your (free!) ticket [here](#). We hope to see many of you there, celebrating the relaunch of OSCN with us!



MAJOR UPDATE TOP GUIDELINES



The landscape of Open Science continues to evolve, and a significant milestone has just been reached with the latest update to the **Transparency and Openness Promotion (TOP) Guidelines**. This major revision, introduced in a new preprint by the **Center for Open Science (COS)**, marks the movement in research integrity, reproducibility, and accountability across scientific disciplines.

Since their launch in 2015, the [TOP Guidelines](#) have provided a structured framework for journals, funders, and institutions to implement Open Science practices. Nearly a decade later, this update incorporates new insights and emerging best practices to further align research outputs with transparency standards.

What's New in the Updated TOP Guidelines?

The revised guidelines introduce **greater flexibility and clarity** while strengthening expectations for transparency. Key updates include:

- **Expanded data, code, and material sharing** policies, promoting stronger adherence to FAIR principles (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable).
- **Enhanced reproducibility standards**, emphasizing documentation and preregistration for studies where applicable.
- **Refined journal and institutional policies**, making it easier for stakeholders to adopt and implement transparency requirements.

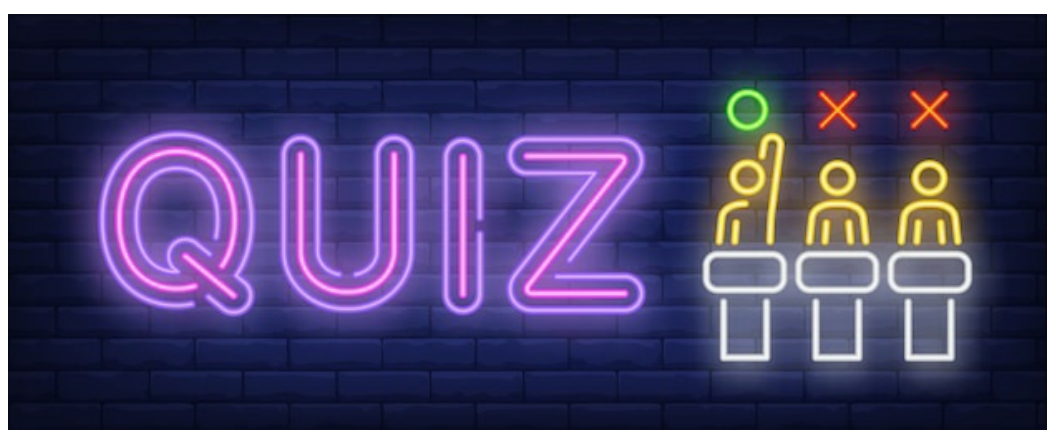
Why Does This Matter?

The updates on the TOP Guidelines call our attention to the importance of emphasising transparency and openness on research practices.

We invite you to explore the updated TOP Guidelines and consider their implications for our academic activities. You can read the full preprint [here](#). Please join the conversation on how we can further integrate these principles into our work. Feel free to reach out for more information or to discuss how these guidelines impact your research!

OPEN SCIENCE GAMES (2)

Last year, we already shared some Open Science games with you (see our [October and November newsletters](#)). Now we're back with some new tips. At the University of Zürich [this online game](#) was developed in which you follow



Emma, a PhD student, and make decisions about how she should perform her research. As in real life, every decision comes with consequences.

If you are more interested in a social quiz-like game - and you don't mind printing the materials yourself - check out the [Open Science in Peril](#) game. This game can be played with 12-20 people and 2-3 hosts. It takes about 60-90 minutes to play.

Let us know, if you know of any other Open Science related game!

NEWS FLASHES

- The [membership form](#) on our website is now adjusted to welcome members from HAN. We are really excited about the fact that OSCN now includes members from four major research institutes in Nijmegen!
- In November we asked you to indicate through what social media channels you would like to hear from us. Based on your input we are now working on a **LinkedIn account for OSCN**. We will keep you posted.
- For those interested in replication research, there is a [NWO Replication Call](#) to fund replication research within the social sciences and humanities (SSH) and ZonMw domains.
- In the most recent episode of [#WeAreRadboud](#), Riyan van den Born talks about the importance of Open Science for her research.



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